CONNECT DAILY

Tuesday 3 November 2026
themapsproject.com

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear "so what for your school" line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, get in touch.

TOP LINE

- Sheffield's own review of children suspended or excluded from its schools finds 65% could have been helped earlier, before their needs worsened, and one in five had no support at all beforehand - figures as reported, the underlying committee paper wasn't available to check directly.
- That goes to today's education, children & families policy committee alongside a proposed 'alternative curriculum strategy' for earlier intervention, due to start next school year if approved.

→ **For your school:** *Worth flagging to MAPs partner schools ahead of next year's rollout.*

- The vote lands amid council turmoil: Sheffield's Labour-Green administration is collapsing over a 'Zionism is racism' motion, with Labour asking Wednesday's full council to let it govern alone - a minority position that could make future decisions, including on this strategy, harder to pass.
- Otherwise a quiet 24-48 hours nationally - no major DfE or Ofsted announcements broke overnight.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

3 Nov 2026 — Sheffield's education, children & families policy committee considers the suspensions/SEND review and proposed alternative curriculum strategy.

4 Nov 2026 — Sheffield full council votes on Labour's plan to govern alone after the Labour-Green administration's collapse.

4 Nov 2026 — Commons Education Committee takes oral evidence from Education Secretary Lucy Powell on the work of the DfE.

INCLUSION, SEND & ALTERNATIVE PROVISION

▪ **Suspended repeatedly before help arrived, Sheffield review finds.** A council review of children suspended or excluded between May and August - drawing on schools, AP providers and families - found 65% could have been supported earlier, before their difficulties deteriorated, and that one in five had received no service beforehand. It goes to today's policy committee alongside a proposed 'alternative curriculum strategy' aimed at earlier intervention, to start next school year if approved. Figures as reported by The Star; flag as unverified against the primary committee paper. (The Star)

→ **For your school:** *Worth flagging to MAPs partner schools ahead of the strategy's rollout next year.*

SHEFFIELD & SOUTH YORKSHIRE

▪ **Council's joint administration set to collapse.** Sheffield's Labour-Green coalition is breaking up after the Greens refused Labour's ultimatum to disavow a 'Zionism is racism' motion passed at their party conference. Labour leader Fran Belbin will ask Wednesday's full council to let Labour govern alone - a minority position that could make passing decisions, including today's SEND strategy, harder in the months ahead. (The Star)

DATA POINT OF THE WEEK

65%

of children suspended or excluded from Sheffield schools this year could have been helped earlier, before their needs worsened, per a city council review - figure as reported, unverified against the primary paper.

The Star / Sheffield City Council review

MAPS IN PRACTICE – TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. Explore School+

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.